



KNOW HOW



❶ How can I get the latest installation Live CDs of Xubuntu, Kubuntu and Ubuntu.

—Noel J Furtado, by e-mail

These distros are free and can be downloaded from www.ubuntu.com/getubuntu/download. The installer CD is around 700 MB. If you do not have a good Internet connection, then you can send a request for a free CD at shipit.ubuntu.com. This service generally takes 6-10 weeks to deliver your CD.

❷ I have downloaded some files from the Internet and they are in the .uif format. Please let me know how to open these files. I am using Fedora on my desktop.

—Tribhuvan, by e-mail

The file format that you have mentioned is created by the Magic ISO, a Windows application that can create, edit, and extract CD/DVD image files. For Windows, there is a freeware tool called MagicDisk that can open UIF images, but in Linux you need to convert it to ISO image files to open it. The fastest way to convert a UIF image to an ISO image is to use UIF2ISO. You can download

and install this command line tool from alvigi.altervista.org/mytools/uif2iso.zip.

After downloading, unzip it and navigate into the `src` directory.

```
unzip uif2iso.zip
cd src
```

Now compile the source by following the commands shown below:

```
make
make install
```

Once you are over with the installation of the program, follow the steps to open your UIF image.

- To open the file, first convert the .uif file to an .iso with the following command:

```
uif2iso abcd.uif xyz.iso
```

- Now burn the ISO image with K3b or any other CD burning tool, or mount the ISO image with the following command:

```
# mkdir iso_dir
# mount xyz.iso iso_dir/ \
-t iso9660 -o loop
```

❸ Recently, due to a sudden power failure, I lost the entire data on my hard disk drive. Is there any software to recover lost data?

—R. Jayaraman, by e-mail

I would suggest that you take the help of some professionals to recover data, especially if it is very critical. Still, you can try a few of the open source applications mentioned below, as they do not have any restrictions like trial software.

- PhotoRec: cgsecurity.org/wiki/PhotoRec

- TestDisk: www.cgsecurity.org
- dcfld: dcfld.sourceforge.net

These tools can also be found on some Live Linux-based CDs (Knoppix, Ubuntu Rescue Remix, SystemRescueCD, etc). You can Google for information on how to download and use these tools.

❹ I'm using CentOS on my desktop and want to know if there are any ways by which I can check my swap usage. I have 512 MB of RAM and have defined 1 GB as swap partition.

—Ashish Mitra, by e-mail

You can check swap usage by using any of the following commands:

```
$ cat /proc/swaps
$ swapon -s
$ free -m
$ top
```

❺ I have been a Windows user for a long time and used FileZilla as my FTP client. Currently I am working on a remote Linux computer with SSH access. Please guide me on how to download a file from another remote FTP server to this server.

—Prakash M., Madurai

You can use the command line `ftp` tool available. To download the file from another remote FTP server, you need to first log in to the FTP server by typing the `ftp <host name>`. This will prompt you for your username and password, if required. After logging in, you can use the `get` or `mget` command to download the file to your local server. To exit the `ftp` prompt, just type `bye`. Check out the man pages about this command for more details. **END** 